UNESCO

UNESCO stands for the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization. It was set up by 37 member nations in November 1945. UNESCO's mission is to promote peace and sustainable development and to reduce poverty through education, the sciences, culture, communication and information.

☞ **1** Insert the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to find out about one of UNESCO's objectives.

Mobilising sc__ __nc__ kn__wl__dg__ and policy for s__st__ __n__bl__ development.

UNESCO is involved in many projects all over the world. Two are to combat global warming and water shortages, especially in poor countries. One part of a project developed especially for children is described below.

☞ **2** Choose the correct word from each pair in brackets in the passage below.

The Big Splash!

During 2011 students were invited to [avoid/participate in] what may be the biggest scientific experiment ever, by UNESCO and IUPAC (the International Union of Pure and Applied Chemistry). With their teachers, children all around the [corner/world] measured pH levels and salinity in [water/sand], filtered and purified the water and then desalinated it. Results were sent to the IUPAC website. Some disadvantaged students were also given a special opportunity to join the big experiment.

On United Nations' World Water Day on 22 March 2011, 1000 pupils from different parts of Cape Town, in South Africa, were shown the difficulties Khayelitsha slum-dwellers face daily in obtaining clean water from a standpipe. [A standpipe is like a garden tap, shared by dozens of families as their only water source.]

The children were then [transported/apparated] to Ratanga Junction to watch a play performed by the Jungle Theatre on the importance of preserving and [wasting/conserving] local water supplies.

Later, the children were handed kits to do their own [experiments/washing up] – they measured the pH of a water sample taken from Intaka Island, a wetland in Cape Town, then filtered and purified the water. For most of the children, this was the [last/first] time they had ever conducted a [culinary/chemistry] experiment. The children were very excited when they did the exercise successfully.

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